

Board 1

East Deals

None Vul

♠ A 7 2
 ♥ Q 5 2
 ♦ K 8 7 4
 ♣ Q J T

♠ K 9 3

♥ 7 4

♦ Q J 6 5

♣ A 8 3 2



♠ T 5

♥ K J 6

♦ A T 9 2

♣ K 9 5 4

♠ Q J 8 6 4

♥ A T 9 8 3

♦ 3

♣ 7 6

West

North

East

South

1 ♦

2 ♦

Pass

2 ♠

All Pass

2 ♠ by North

The bidding has been as shown.

A perfect Michaels example; 5-5 in the Majors and 9 points. You bid 2 ♦ and partner says 2 ♠.

You have a rather minimum Michaels type hand and you asked partner to choose a Major suit. He chose ♠s. But don't start thinking about what great support you have for his ♠ suit, he doesn't **HAVE** a ♠ suit, he is just supporting yours. In other words, you pass.

Board 2

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A T 8 6 3
♥ A T 9 7 4
♦ 8 6
♣ 5

♠ 7 2

♥ J 6 5 2

♦ K 9 3

♣ A J 4 3



♠ J 9 5

♥ K 8 3

♦ A J T 5

♣ 9 7 6

♠ K Q 4

♥ Q

♦ Q 7 4 2

♣ K Q T 8 2

The bidding has been as shown.

You have a fair hand with a guaranteed 8-card fit in either Major. You are not, however, strong enough to jump the bidding. So you bid 2♥, which is passed out.

West

North

East

South

2♣

Pass

2♥

1♣

All Pass

2♥ by East

Board 3

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ J 9
♥ A K 6 4 2
♦ A J 8 6 2
♣ 2

♠ 7 5

♥ 9

♦ K T 9 7 4

♣ K Q J 6 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K Q T 8 3

♥ J T 5

♦ 5

♣ T 8 7 4

♠ A 6 4 2

♥ Q 8 7 3

♦ Q 3

♣ A 9 5

West

1 ♥

All Pass

3 ♣ by South

North

2NT

East

Pass

South

3 ♣

The bidding has been as shown.

You have a pretty good hand for an Unusual Notrump, but not so good that you wouldn't use the convention. You bid 2NT and partner says 3 ♣. What do you say next?

As mentioned, you have a pretty good hand, but partner only bid because you forced him to and he showed nothing more than minimum. So you pass.

Board 4

North Deals

Both Vul

♠ J 7 5
♥ A J 9 7 3
♦ 9 6 5
♣ J 2

♠ A Q T 8 3 2

♥ K Q T

♦ A

♣ 8 6 3



♠ 9 6

♥ 4

♦ K Q J 8 4

♣ K Q T 7 5

♠ K 4

♥ 8 6 5 2

♦ T 7 3 2

♣ A 9 4

The bidding has been as shown.

Your best suit is ♥s. But partner didn't ask you to bid ♥s, he asked you to pick a Minor. You know you will have an 8-card fit in ♦s so you take the safe approach and bid 3♦. Everybody passes.

West

North

East

South

1♠

2NT

Pass

3♦

All Pass

3♦ by West

Board 5

East Deals

None Vul

♠ Q T 5
 ♥ 6
 ♦ K Q J T 8 4
 ♣ 9 7 4

♠ 8 6 3

♥ K 7 5 3 2

♦ A 9 7 5

♣ Q



♠ A K J 9 4 2

♥ A Q

♦ 3 2

♣ A 8 6

♠ 7

♥ J T 9 8 4

♦ 6

♣ K J T 5 3 2

West

North

East

South

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by North

1♠

2♠

The bidding has been as shown.

Of course you bid a Michaels Cue-Bid of 2♠.

Partner says 4♥.

Partner's jump might indicate he has a really good hand, or he might just have a really good fit. You certainly don't have the strength to make another move so you pass. A good thing, too. Partner might get lucky and make this but it looks like the other guys are cold for 4♠. Even if partner loses 2♥ tricks and goes down 1 it will turn out to be a good sacrifice.

Board 6

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A K T 6
♥ A K J 9
♦ K 6
♣ K J 2

♠ Q J 8 5
♥ Q 8 5 3 2
♦ A Q 4
♣ 7



♠ 7 4
♥ 6
♦ J 9 8 7 3
♣ A Q T 8 5

♠ 9 3 2
♥ T 7 4
♦ T 5 2
♣ 9 6 4 3

West

North
1 ♥East
2NTSouth
Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

The bidding has been as shown.

You have no idea what you can make with this hand.
Slam in one of the minors may be possible, but
maybe not. You decide to try 3NT.

Board 7

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q T 4
 ♥ K T 5 3
 ♦ A 7
 ♣ A T 8 6

♠ 8 7

♥ Q J 9 8 4

♦ K J T 5 3

♣ 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K J 6 5 2

♥ 7 2

♦ 6

♣ 9 7 5 4 3

♠ A 9 3

♥ A 6

♦ Q 9 8 4 2

♣ K Q J

West

1 ♣

North

2NT

East

Pass

South

4 ♦

All Pass

4 ♦ by South

The bidding has been as shown.

With the two lowest unbid suits you bid 2NT. Partner jumps to 4 ♦.

Partner probably has a good hand, but he might just be preempting. Assuming he is inviting you to bid game you have a tough decision. You are not very strong but you might have been a couple of points weaker. It is strictly a judgement call and we decide to pass.

As you can see, **IF** they open the lead with a ♣, and **IF** the ♥ finesse then works, you can make 5 ♦.

Board 8

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A J T 6

♥ 7 4

♦ A 7 6

♣ A T 9 5

♠ -

♥ A 8 5 3

♦ Q 9 8 4 3

♣ K Q 8 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 9 8 7 4

♥ Q J T 9 6

♦ 5

♣ 7 4

♠ Q 5 3 2

♥ K 2

♦ K J T 2

♣ J 3 2

West

North

East

South

3 ♠

1 ♦

2 ♦

Pass

Pass

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by West

The bidding has been as shown.

As you have figured out by now, using Michaels Cue-Bids / Unusual Notrump is sometimes hard to tie down. Here you have 13/14 points and if you figure partner for 9 that won't be enough for game. But, those two Minor Aces are worth a lot when you figure partner has only 3 Minor suit cards.

So let's say you decide to just invite with 3 ♠. Partner takes you to game.

You will surely make this game if trumps split 2-2. If they don't then you will have to hope for a defensive mistake.

Board 9

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 9 8 4 3
♥ A 5
♦ A Q 8 6 2
♣ A

♠ T
♥ Q J 9 8 4
♦ K J T 5 3
♣ J 2



♠ 6 5 2
♥ K T 7 3 2
♦ -
♣ Q T 9 7 3

♠ K Q J 7
♥ 6
♦ 9 7 4
♣ K 8 6 5 4

West	North	East	South
1 ♠	2 ♠	Pass	2NT
Pass	3 ♦		
All Pass			
3 ♦ by North			

The bidding has been as shown.

With 5 cards in the "other" Major and a 5-card Minor you bid 2♠, Michaels of course. Partner bids 2NT. What do you say next?

Is it possible that partner wants to play Notrump? Not at all. He hates ♥s and wants you to bid your Minor suit. So you say 3♦ and he passes.

Board 10

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ K Q
 ♥ A K Q 8 3
 ♦ Q J T 5 4
 ♣ 3

♠ J 7 5 4 3

♥ T 9 6 2

♦ 8

♣ K J 4



♠ T 6

♥ 7 4

♦ K 7 6 3

♣ A T 9 6 5

♠ A 9 8 2

♥ J 5

♦ A 9 2

♣ Q 8 7 2

The bidding has been as shown.

Partner asked you to choose between ♥s and ♦s so you bid 3♦. He then raises you to 4♦.

If you say to yourself "I only have 7 HCP" then you might pass. But if you say "Partner invited me to bid game, even though I might have no points and only 3 trumps. I'm a lot better than that.", then you will accept the invitation. So you bid 5♦ and everybody passes.

West	North	East	South
			1♣
2NT	Pass	3♦	Pass
4♦	Pass	5♦	
All Pass			
5♦ by East			

Board 11

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 7 2
 ♥ K T
 ♦ J 9 8 4 2
 ♣ T 9 4 2

♠ K T 9 3

♥ J 6 5 2

♦ K 6

♣ K Q 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 8 4

♥ A Q 8 7 4 3

♦ 7

♣ A J 8 7

♠ A Q J 6 5

♥ 9

♦ A Q T 5 3

♣ 6 3

West

North

East

South

Pass

2♥

Pass

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by South

The bidding has been as shown.

With 5 cards in the "other" Major and a 5-card Minor suit this looks like an ideal Michaels Cue-Bid, right? No, not really. While it would not be a capital offense to bid 2♥ here, it generally works out better with 13-16 point hands to just overcall in your higher-ranking suit. You bid 1♠. Partner responds 2♥.

Partner's cue-bid shows a limit-raise or better in ♠s. So you bid 4♠ without the blink of an eye.

Board 12

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A T 9 8 3

♥ 8

♦ 7 5

♣ Q J T 7 4

♠ Q J 5 4 2

♥ Q T 3

♦ A 8 2

♣ A 3



♠ 6

♥ K 6 4 2

♦ K T 9 3

♣ K 8 6 5

♠ K 7

♥ A J 9 7 5

♦ Q J 6 4

♣ 9 2

The bidding has been as shown.

Partner is 5-5 in ♠s and one of the Minor suits.

Forget ♠s, you want him to bid the Minor. So you bid 2NT. Partner says 3♣.

Partner only made a minimum bid, so you have no choice but to pass.

West

North

East

South

2♥

Pass

2NT

1♥

3♣

Pass

All Pass

3♣ by West

Board 13

East Deals

None Vul

♠ J 9 4
 ♥ A 3 2
 ♦ T 4 2
 ♣ Q J 9 6

♠ 7 6 2

♥ J 9 5

♦ Q J 8

♣ 7 5 4 2



♠ Q T

♥ 8 6

♦ A K 9 7 6 3

♣ K T 8

♠ A K 8 5 3

♥ K Q T 7 4

♦ 5

♣ A 3

The bidding has been as shown.

With 18 points and 5-5 Major suits you are up in the high-level Michaels category. You bid 2♦ and partner responds 2♥.

Yes, you have a high-level Michaels hand but don't get carried away. Remember that you forced partner to bid. Any bid at all by you at this point will show 17+ points, so you just raise to 3♥. Partner has a weak hand and passes.

West	North	East	South
		1♦	2♦
Pass	2♥	Pass	3♥
All Pass			
3♥ by North			

Board 14

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 4
♥ A T 9 6 4
♦ K Q 6 5 2
♣ 8

♠ 3 2
♥ K Q 5
♦ A T 8
♣ Q T 7 5 3



♠ Q J T 8 7 6 5
♥ 8 3
♦ 7 4
♣ A 6

♠ A K
♥ J 7 2
♦ J 9 3
♣ K J 9 4 2

The bidding has been as shown.

Partner wants you to bid ♥s or ♦s. You figure that in either of the red suits you will have a 7-card fit. You hope to do better than that in ♠s. So you bid 3♠ and everybody passes.

West	North	East	South
			1♣
2NT	Pass	3♠	
All Pass			
3♠ by East			

Board 15

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A 5
 ♥ 8 5 3
 ♦ K 3 2
 ♣ K Q 8 5 4

♠ K Q T 6 2

♥ A K Q 7 4

♦ 5

♣ A 3



♠ 8 7

♥ T 9 2

♦ A Q J 9 8

♣ J T 2

♠ J 9 4 3

♥ J 6

♦ T 7 6 4

♣ 9 7 6

West

1 ♣

Pass

All Pass

4 ♠ by South

North

2 ♣

4 ♠

East

Pass

South

2 ♠

The bidding has been as shown.

You have 20 points and two good 5-card Majors so you bid a Michaels 2 ♣. Partner responds 2 ♠. What do you say next?

Partner may have as few as zero points and as many as 13 or so. You **COULD** bid an invitational 3 ♠, but if he has only 5 or 6 points he will pass. Looking at your hand you only need to find partner with ♠ J x x to have a good shot at game. So go ahead and bid 4 ♠.

Will you look at that. Partner has only 2 points, but what great ones to have!

Board 16

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 6
♥ K Q T 8
♦ 7 4 2
♣ A K 6 5

♠ 3

♥ J 7 6

♦ A K Q 9 6 3

♣ Q J 8



♠ K 9 8 5 2

♥ A 9 4 3 2

♦ T 5

♣ 9

♠ Q J T 7 4

♥ 5

♦ J 8

♣ T 7 4 3 2

West

North

East

South

1♦

2♦

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by West

The bidding has been as shown.

Partner has 5 of each Major suit so you know of a good 9-card ♥ fit. You have a nice hand and must decide between inviting with 3♥ or bidding the game on your own. You decide to bid the game so you say 4♥ and everybody passes.

Board 17

West Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J T 9 2

♥ J 9 8 2

♦ J 9

♣ A K

♠ 4

♥ 6

♦ K 8 7 5 2

♣ Q J 9 7 6 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 8 6 5

♥ Q T 7 5 4 3

♦ T 4

♣ 2

♠ A 7 3

♥ A K

♦ A Q 6 3

♣ T 8 5 3

West

1 ♠

Pass

All Pass

5 ♣ by North

North

2NT

4 ♣

East

Pass

Pass

South

3 ♠

5 ♣

The bidding has been as shown.

This is a really good hand for Unusual Notrump. You bid 2NT and partner says 3 ♠.

Partner apparently has a big hand. His cue-bid is forcing, and probably means he wants to be in game. But for now you can just show your minimum strength and give a suit preference. You bid 4 ♣ and partner raises to 5 ♣.

Board 18

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K 8
♥ K 7 5
♦ A 6 3
♣ T 9 7 3 2

♠ T 4

♥ J 6

♦ Q T 9 7 4 2

♣ K 6 5



♠ A 9 6 2

♥ Q T 3

♦ J 8

♣ A Q J 8

♠ Q J 7 5 3

♥ A 9 8 4 2

♦ K 5

♣ 4

The bidding has been as shown.

Many times at Bridge you want to fight for the contract. This isn't one of them. With 6 HCP and only four cards total in partner's two suits just let the opponents have it. You pass.

West

North

East

South

1 ♣

2 ♣

3 ♣

All Pass

3 ♣ by East

Board 19

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A J
 ♥ A J T 5
 ♦ K T 8 5 2
 ♣ 5 2

♠ Q T 6 5 2

♥ K Q 9 7 3

♦ 7

♣ J 9



♠ K 9 8 4 3

♥ 8 4

♦ Q J 9 3

♣ T 6

♠ 7

♥ 6 2

♦ A 6 4

♣ A K Q 8 7 4 3

West

1 ♦

North

2 ♦

East

Pass

South

3 ♣

All Pass

3 ♣ by South

The bidding has been as shown.

With two 5-card Majors of course you bid 2 ♦.

Partner responds 3 ♣.

This wasn't according to your script. Partner was supposed to choose a Major. The reason he didn't, of course, is that he didn't like either one and figured you would be better in ♣s. So you pass.

Board 20

North Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q 8 7 4

♥ T 6 5

♦ 7

♣ A 9 7 5 2

♠ A 3

♥ Q J

♦ K Q J 9 3

♣ K Q 8 3



♠ K J T 5 2

♥ A 9 7 4 3

♦ 6 2

♣ T

♠ 9 6

♥ K 8 2

♦ A T 8 5 4

♣ J 6 4

West

North

East

South

1 ♦

2 ♦

3 ♦

3 ♠

All Pass

3 ♠ by West

The bidding has been as shown.

You don't have a great hand but you **DO** have 4 ♠s. So don't let the opponents have a 3-level contract when your side has 9 ♠s. Bid 3 ♠.

Note: See the Law of Total Tricks Lesson on this topic.